

## GENERAL NOTES

**Comments invited:** While every care is taken by all our staff members to assure the accuracy of the contents of this publication, we cannot -- with such vast material -- preclude errors. We therefore *invite your suggestions concerning any errors that you might detect, but also your comments on any estimates or opinions with which you disagree.*

**Scope:** The analyses and world balances of this publication cover the following commodities:

**10 Oilseeds:** soybeans, cottonseed, groundnuts (shelled basis, 70% of unshelled unless otherwise stated), sunflowerseed, rapeseed, sesameseed, palmkernels, copra, linseed and castorseed.

**17 Oils & Fats:** the oils from the above ten oilseeds plus corn oil, olive oil, palm oil, fish oil (all marine oils except from mammals), butter, lard, tallow and greases.

**12 Major Oilmeals:** the expellers, extraction meals, pellets & other residues from the above oilseeds except castorseed, but also fish meal, corn germ meal & corn glutenfeed.

**Sources/coverage:** All figures without an asterisk are from official national sources, while those with an asterisk are estimates made by OIL WORLD. Population data are based on those of the UN Population Division and are mid-year data (as of July 1 of each year). GDP data in most cases are from the International Monetary Fund, national sources or OIL WORLD estimates.

Coverage is complete for most countries. Only for some smaller countries the production and/or trade and thus also disappearance/new supplies are somewhat incomplete. But in our world tables any data missing for individual countries are included in "other countries", so that the world totals are always complete.

**Time reference:** As a general rule, each season comprises the crops harvested in the 'first year' in the northern hemisphere and the 'second year' in the southern hemisphere.

For example: For the world crop season 2018/19 our statistics include the production of the northern hemisphere countries during the second half of 2018 (harvesting mostly taking place between July and November) plus the southern hemisphere crops generally harvested in early 2019. In other words, the Brazilian soybean crop harvested from February until May 2019 is included in the 2018/19 world crop season.

In our world surveys of crushings as well as of oil and meal output, exports, etc., all data refer exactly to the periods shown in the header.

**Harvested areas** of oil and coconut palms refer to the average mature area of the calendar year (second of the split year). In most tables the unit is 1000 hectares.

**Production:** Vegetable oil and meal data refer to actual production in the countries where the crush is taking place. Estimates, where necessary, have been made on the basis of oilseed production, seed/feed/loss as well as monthly oilseed imports, exports & stocks. Production data for vegetable oils refer to crude oils.

**Stocks:** Vegetable oil stocks comprise crude, refined and further processed oils, tel quel. The inventories of oils, fats and meals exclude '*invisible stocks*', i.e. the unreported stocks at end-consumers. In the case of meals stocks statistics are hardly available; and, where they are, they mostly refer to crushing plants and are often incomplete.

The '*visible stocks*' included in our statistics either represent the officially reported stocks or our OIL WORLD estimates of inventories at oil mills and, in the case of oils & fats, at refiners and hardeners and partly also at secondary manufacturers, wholesalers and port storage/handling facilities.

For Argentina (soya oil and sun oil), Canada (rape oil) and for other countries we usually do not use the officially reported stocks at crushing plants but add estimates at export locations or other places, which are partly substantial.

**Disappearance** is calculated as the residual of the balance, i.e. visible opening stocks *plus* production and imports *minus* exports and visible ending stocks. Where stocks are unavailable, the data represent 'new supplies' (production plus imports minus exports).

The disappearance or the 'new supplies' are in a few cases negative. This means that actual consumption (which, of course, is positive) has been covered by reducing visible and/or invisible stocks.

'Disappearance' of oils & fats includes food and non-food uses.

'Domestic disappearance' data of certain countries also include the oils & fats used for manufacturing secondary products that are finally exported (but not included in our export figures). This refers above all to margarine, ghee, shortenings, salad and cooking oils but also biscuits, soaps, oleo-chemicals and other products containing oils and fats.

Therefore, in all the net exporting countries of such secondary products our 'domestic disappearance' is overstated and in all net importing countries understated.

**Per capita disappearance** of oils and fats is included in most major country balances in the Country Section. Since it is the quotient of population and disappearance, the facts referred to under 'domestic disappearance' in the preceding paragraph are also inflating 'per capita usage' in a few countries.

Disappearance statistics of oilmeals have been calculated as the residual of the balance, but in many cases the information on stocks and stock changes are not available. In those cases the meal disappearance actually reflects "new supplies of oilmeals", calculated as production plus imports minus exports.

But in some cases (primarily for soybean meal and fish meal) we include in our statistics the stocks numbers (reflecting official data in some cases or our OIL WORLD estimates in others). But it should be noted that stocks of soybean meal and in some cases also of sunflower meal, rapeseed meal and a few other meals, generally refer to crushing plants only, and must therefore be considered incomplete.

The **raw protein content of oilmeals** is calculated on the basis of the following rates (in %): soybean meal 46, cotton meal 40, groundnut meal 52, sunseed meal 41, rape meal 33, sesame meal 40, corn meal 13, corn gluten feed as well as copra meal 20, palm kernel meal 17, lin meal 36 and fish meal 65.

**The trade data** for oils and fats generally include only crude & refined, tel quel, i.e. they generally exclude further processed oils and fats. In the case of palm oil and fish oil, however, further processed oils are included in the trade data of most countries. The data for oilseed meals/cakes exclude castorseed and other residues normally not used for feed.

All export data include re-exports. Import data for the USA represent 'imports for consumption'.

-- Source data referring to periods other than the calendar year (e.g. Australia: July/June, Iran: April/March, etc.) have been properly adjusted to Jan/Dec and Oct/Sept, respectively.

**GDP Growth:** For most countries we include at the end of the supply and demand balances for oils and fats the change in the real Gross Domestic Product in percent relative to a year earlier. This is considered to be an important demand factor and might thus be helpful to explain the changes in the domestic disappearance.

GDP data are for most countries available only on a calendar-year basis. Consequently, we show, for instance, for Oct/Sept 2018/19 the change in the GDP for calendar year 2019.

**Butter** is always shown on a fat basis. Stocks, production and trade have been converted to fat basis at 84% for the EU, 83% for Australia, 78% for the ex-USSR and in all other cases 82%. For India and Pakistan butter (animal ghee) production is reported as 100% fat basis. -- For most countries production data exclude farm butter. Production includes also butter ghee.

**Smuggling** (illegal foreign trade) is generally not included in exports and imports. Thus any amounts exported illegally are shown in the domestic disappearance of the exporting country (thus overstating it, whilst the imports and disappearance of the importing country are understated).

Here are a few examples where smuggling apparently is taking place: 1) from Pakistan to Afghanistan; 2) from India to Pakistan, 3) from Malaysia to Thailand; and 4) from Iran and Jordan to Iraq. -- The domestic disappearance of all countries involved in smuggling may therefore show undue fluctuations.

#### Stop-press deadlines:

The deadline for all the statistics, analyses and projections was 24 June, 2026, for some already earlier.

#### SYMBOLS & UNITS

|     |                                                                                                           |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| *   | OIL WORLD estimate                                                                                        |
| r   | Revised                                                                                                   |
| p   | Preliminary                                                                                               |
| -   | No imports, exports etc.                                                                                  |
| .   | Less than half of the unit used                                                                           |
| ..  | No figure available (estimated amounts, if any, are included in "other")                                  |
| ... | Working estimate of crops and harvested area (not reliable enough to be shown, but included in the total) |
| ha  | Hectare (2.471 acres)                                                                                     |
| bu  | bushel                                                                                                    |
| T   | Metric tonne (1000 kilos)                                                                                 |
| ST  | Short Ton (907.2 kilos)                                                                                   |
| LT  | Long Ton (1016 kilos)                                                                                     |
| Thd | Thousand                                                                                                  |
| Mn  | Million                                                                                                   |
| Bn  | Billion                                                                                                   |